

The Managing Director
National Commodity and Derivatives Exchange Ltd.
Kanjurmarg, Mumbai – 400078

Dear Sir,

Request for Data for the Purpose of Research / Analysis

On behalf of the ___ Indian Institute of Technology, Guwahati ___ (name of the institution), I request you to provide me data as per details given in Annexure I. The said data shall be shared for research/ analysis, which are more detailed in Annexure II.

I agree to:

1. Hold the data confidential at my end and use it only for the purpose as per Annexure II. To that extent, I am willing to sign a separate Non-Disclosure Agreement with NCDEX.
2. Pay NCDEX a fee, as may be decided by NCDEX, to defray the expenses related to processing and providing the data.
3. Agree to any other condition(s) put forth by NCDEX, including condition(s) for (i) maintaining confidentiality and integrity of the data being provided; (ii) sharing the output/ results of the research work; (iii) any other purpose.

Yours faithfully,

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Institution Seal



भारतीय प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान गुवाहाटी

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY GUWAHATI

Annexure I

Data Request

Contract-wise daily bhavcopy (end-of-day futures data), i.e., one record per contract expiry per trading day, for all contract expiries of each commodity listed below.

1. Trading date (DD-MM-YYYY)
2. Commodity symbol (as per exchange nomenclature)
3. Contract expiry date (contract identifier)
4. Open price (Rs, per exchange quotation unit)
5. High price (Rs)
6. Low price (Rs)
7. Close price (Rs)
8. Settlement price / previous close (as published by the exchange)
9. Traded volume (in lots and/or quantity in MT)
10. Traded value (Rs lakh/crore, as maintained)
11. Open interest (end-of-day, per contract, in lots)

Commodities and date ranges:

1. Suspended commodities -Wheat, Chana, Mustard Seed complex, Soybean complex (incl. refined soy oil), Paddy (non-basmati), Moong: 01-01-2017 to the last traded date before the 20-12-2021 suspension, including any post-suspension settlement records of then-live contracts, if published.
2. Comparison commodities -Guar Seed, Castor Seed, Turmeric, Jeera, Kapas: 01-01-2017 to 30-04-2026 (or latest available date).

Format: CSV preferred (Excel acceptable); file organisation per commodity, per contract, or pooled - whichever is convenient to the exchange.

Supplementary (optional, if maintained):

1. Daily polled spot prices for the above commodities at the respective basis centres, same date ranges.
2. Any participant-category-wise open interest (e.g., hedger/FPO vs client vs proprietary) at commodity level, which would materially strengthen the market-composition component of the study.

Annexure II

About the Research Work

1. Details of the research / Analysis for which data is being sought

The study is an empirical evaluation of the December 2021 suspension of derivatives trading in seven agricultural commodities, intended for peer-reviewed journal publication. It asks whether the suspension achieved its stated objective — moderating food price volatility — and at what cost to market functions. The analysis tests hypotheses on: (i) spot price volatility before vs after suspension, using difference-in-differences and synthetic-control designs with non-suspended commodities as the comparison group; (ii) price discovery, via cointegration and information-share methods (Hasbrouck 1995; Gonzalo–Granger 1995) between futures, domestic spot, and international benchmark prices; (iii) spot market efficiency and seasonal price patterns; (iv) insulation of domestic prices from international shocks; and (v) changes in market composition and hedging activity around the suspension. The sample window is January 2017 to the present, covering roughly five pre-suspension years and the suspension period.

2. Justify how the data sought (at each field level) is necessary for the research project, to test the specific hypothesis:

- a. Trading date, symbol, contract expiry: identify each contract uniquely so continuous price series can be constructed with documented, replicable roll rules; expiry identity is also needed to study term structure (near- vs far-month spreads) and expiry-related effects. Pre-built continuous series from commercial vendors embed undocumented roll conventions, which is unacceptable for replicable published research.
- b. Close / settlement price: core input - daily returns and realized volatility (hypothesis i); basis computation against spot (iii); cointegration with spot and international prices (ii, iv).
- c. Open, high, low: range-based volatility estimators (Parkinson; Garman–Klass) as robustness checks on close-to-close volatility - important because volatility is the headline outcome variable; also used to identify non-traded days (zero ranges) so stale quotes do not contaminate return series.
- d. Traded volume and traded value: liquidity controls in all regressions; volume-based roll rules for continuous-series construction; identification of thinly traded contracts whose prices are unreliable; analysis of whether trading activity migrated across contracts and commodities around the suspension.
- e. Open interest (per contract): measures hedging/position-taking activity and its term structure; essential for the market-composition hypothesis (v), complementing the

participant-category data SEBI publishes only at monthly frequency; daily contract-level OI is published in bhavcopy but not recoverable from any vendor source.

- f. Post-suspension settlement records: needed to document the stale-quote regime after 20-12-2021 so no analysis mistakes settlement marks for traded prices — a methodological error present in earlier commentary on this episode.
- g. Comparison commodities, full window to 2026: these serve as the counterfactual ("donor pool") in difference-in-differences and synthetic-control designs and must span the post-suspension period to identify treatment effects.

3. Details of past related research work, along with publications, if any.

The study builds directly on the empirical literature on Indian agricultural derivatives suspensions: the Expert Committee on Futures Trading (Chair: Abhijit Sen, 2008); post-2008 ban studies (Nair 2011; Lingareddy 2008, 2015; Sahadevan; Bose); Aggarwal, Jain & Thomas (IGIDR WP-2014-020) on price discovery and risk management in Indian commodity futures; and the emerging work on the 2021 suspension specifically — Aggarwal, Chatterjee & Sehgal (SSRN WP 4261360, synthetic-control evaluation), Dey & Gairola (Economic & Political Weekly, 2024), and the 2024 empirical reports by IIT Bombay (SJMSOM) and BIMTECH. The present study extends this work with a longer post-suspension window, contract-level exchange data, and a unified benefit-and-cost evaluation across multiple market functions.

I have no prior publications in this area; this study is a research project.